

PARENT PLAYBOOK

How to raise a struggling reader who believes in themselves

Dyslexia in children is not a lack of intelligence. Richard Branson is dyslexic. Here's how to turn a struggling reader's brain into creativity, grit, and a real strength.

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The quick answer

What is dyslexia? Dyslexia is a common, brain-based difference that makes reading, spelling, and word retrieval harder - despite normal or high intelligence. It is not caused by laziness, poor teaching, or low ability. With the right support, dyslexic children learn to read, and their thinking strengths - creativity, big-picture reasoning, problem-solving - often become their superpower.

DO THIS

How to raise a struggling reader who believes in themselves

Work through these in order. Small, daily reps beat one big push.

1

Get the right reading help early

Dyslexia responds to structured, specialist teaching. Ask the school for an assessment and support - don't wait and hope.

2

Separate reading from intelligence - out loud

Tell your child often: 'Reading is hard for your brain. Thinking is not. They are different things.'

3

Feed the strengths

Give real outlets for ideas - building, art, business games, debate, audiobooks. Let them shine where they're strong while reading catches up.

4

Tell them the stories

Branson, and so many founders and inventors, are dyslexic. Kids need proof that this brain wins.

KEEP AN EYE OUT

The hidden strengths of a dyslexic child

- * Big-picture thinking: seeing how things connect, not just the details.
- * Creativity: original ideas and unusual solutions.

- * Problem-solving and reasoning: finding a way around, not just through.
- * Storytelling and people skills: many dyslexics communicate and lead brilliantly.

PARENT FAQ

Quick answers

Does dyslexia mean my child isn't intelligent?

No. Dyslexia has nothing to do with intelligence. It makes reading, spelling, and word retrieval harder, but dyslexic children are often fast, creative thinkers with strong reasoning. Many are highly intelligent. The struggle is with reading mechanics, not with thinking.

What are the strengths of a child with dyslexia?

Dyslexic minds are often strong at big-picture thinking, creativity, problem-solving, storytelling, and leadership. Organisations led by dyslexics describe these as 'dyslexic thinking' - the very skills the modern world rewards most. The reading struggle sits right next to real, usable gifts.

How can I help my child with dyslexia?

Get early, structured reading support - ask the school for an assessment. At home, separate reading from intelligence out loud, feed their strengths with hands-on outlets, and share stories of successful dyslexics. Support the reading while fiercely protecting their belief in their own mind.

Can a dyslexic child still be successful?

Absolutely. Richard Branson and many other founders, inventors, and leaders are dyslexic. With the right reading help and strong self-belief, dyslexic children often turn their thinking strengths into remarkable careers. Dyslexia is a different way of learning, not a limit on success.

Should I tell my child they have dyslexia?

Yes, framed well. Children do better knowing their brain works differently than believing they're 'stupid' or 'lazy.' Explain that reading is hard for their brain but thinking is not, name the strengths that come with it, and point to the many successful people who share it.

READING HELPS. PRACTICE STICKS.

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